> The essential purpose as I judge it was strikingly to increase the Soviet Union's military strength relative to that of the United States, and thereby to improve the Soviet Union's bargaining power. I do not believe that objective related primarily to a particular issue (i.e. Berlin) at a particular time (i.e. this month) but that it was intended to apply to all issues and for the foreseeable future.[92]

We now know that during the crisis Berlin did not figure in Khrushchev's calculations. In Moscow (though certainly not in Washington or London), West Berlin was the elephant in the room (something that everyone knew was present, but no-one wanted to talk about). There were Soviet officials, like Ambassador Dobrynin, who thought the blockade of Cuba merited a response against West Berlin. The only person in the Kremlin who pointed at the elephant seems to have been first Deputy Foreign Minister, Vasily Kuznetsov. Khrushchev's abrupt response was, 'We are here trying to get ourselves out of this *avantyura* [reckless gamble] and now you are pulling us into another one.'[93]

Arguably, one of the most significant consequences of the Cuban missile crisis was that it marked an end to the risk that the status of Berlin could escalate into a major confrontation. Some commentators have alluded to Khrushchev's inaction against West Berlin as 'the dog that did not bark in the night'. In Sir Arthur Conan Doyle's short story, *The Adventure of Silver Blaze*,Sherlock Holmes solves the case by deducing that the fact that 'the dog did not bark in the night' meant an intruder was not involved. That Khrushchev did not retaliate against Berlin was not 'the dog that did bark in the night' (because the fact that he did not move against Berlin was not the reason he deployed the missiles in Cuba).

While Berlin may not have been foremost in Khrushchev's thinking when he decided to deploy missiles in Cuba, it was very much in the mind of President Kennedy (and of Prime Minister Macmillan) when the missiles were discovered. Indeed, when JFK decided on the blockade, he believed the Soviets would react against Berlin. Of all the Western misperceptions and misjudgements, this was perhaps the most striking. Nevertheless, had